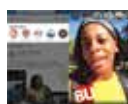




iPads can prep flights

Singapore Airline's technology initiative removes the need for prep work before takeoff on the pilots' end by doing it for them. <https://dgit.in/dec18-50-1>



Stories on LinkedIn?

LinkedIn gives in to the stories trend and have begun testing Snapchat-style stories called 'Student Voices'. <https://dgit.in/dec18-50-2>

FiiO F3

Good audio at a good price point

The FiiO F3 is mainly plastic, with a silicone casing on the coiled cable. The interchangeable faceplates allow you to customise the look of the individual driver housing. The flexible ear guides are also optional and help you get a better grip when you put the IEMs on your ear in the intended over-ear style.

As we've come to expect from a FiiO headphone, the F3 punches above its weight. The bass is fast and punchy, providing a level of detail and sharpness that is not seen often in its immediate competitors. It gets around the muddiness that plagues its counterparts and manages to offer you the low-rumble of the sub-bass and an overall linear boost without ruining the experience with sheer loudness and vibration.

Compared to the bass, the mids come across as slightly recessed. Chris Rea in *Call of Me* and Adele in *Hello* sound a bit soft, with Rea struggling a bit more to be heard. However, the vocal performance is still better than many other units we've tried in this range.

When it comes to the highs, the F3s shine once again. The v-shaped signature of the overall sound comes through with tracks like *Pull Me Under* by Dream Theater, *Hotel California* by The Eagles and more. There's a decent amount of soundstaging and imaging going on for a budget earphone, something that only improves when driven by a dedicated AMP. Tracks like *Hunter* by Bjork sound reasonably well-spaced and detailed. The microphone performance on the F3 is also quite adequate.

While the Ant Audio W59 does come at ₹300 less than this, the jump in audio quality here is worth it. We recommend the FiiO F3 for the lower end of the budget IEM segment.

—Arnab Mukherjee

SPECIFICATIONS

TYPE: Dynamic (11mm) | FREQUENCY RESPONSE: 15Hz ~ 20kHz | SENSITIVITY: 98 dB/mW | IMPEDANCE: 40 Ω | PLUG: 3.5mm L-shaped gold-plated stereo | CORD LENGTH: 1.2 m | WEIGHT: 19.6 g

CONTACT

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Sony WH-1000XM3

Raising the bar on noise cancelling headphones

The Sony WH-1000x Mark 3 is designed keeping the traveller in mind – the retail box contains a travel case with a 3.5mm balanced cable, a USB Type-C cable for charging, and a converter that lets you plug the headphones into the audio output found on-board most aeroplanes. The headband itself has also changed in two ways, but you will only notice one of them. It's easy to spot the considerably plush padding around the top band that's been added for comfort. The second is only noticeable when you wear the headphones, and realise that the headband now wraps a lot closer to the side of your face than the Mark 2.

As soon as the music starts to play, you feel the bass-heavy bias of the headphones. Thankfully there's a tight response, and no bleeding of the bass into the mids or the highs. For those with a love for rock and all things rebellious, the WH-1000x Mark 3 offers an above average experience out of the box. You can also quickly tweak the EQ using the headphone connect app to suit your tastes. The Active Noise Cancellation can be tuned through 20 intensity points, allowing you to choose what you hear. Sony says that the headphones should give 30 hours of playback with all the bells and whistles. We ended up getting about 24 hours out of one charge and the charge time is roughly 3 hours. This is a very minute refinement over the Mark 2, so you might not want to upgrade from that. If you don't own the predecessor and want exceptional audio quality, this won't disappoint.

—Swapnil Mathur

SPECIFICATIONS

HEADPHONE TYPE: Closed, dynamic | DRIVER UNIT: 1.57", dome, neodymium | IMPEDANCE: 47 ohm | FREQUENCY RESPONSE: 20-20 kHz | CONNECTIVITY: 3.5 mm, Bluetooth | CORD LENGTH: 1.2 m.

CONTACT

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